# Section 5: Traditional Proverbs & Idioms (Part 1 of 4)

Source: Rev. William Pettigrew 1918 Grammar (pp. 116-120) -- Deduplicated & Verified

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**1. [idiom_01] Ra-chay-li theingui-shai-lu, rit-linga-lung khang-san-lu, kachi k**

Literal: Roasting fruit when thirsty, or putting a stone on an already heavy
Application: Applies to a person who adds to his misery by repeated silly actions
Parallel: Adding fuel to fire / Adding insult to injury

**2. [idiom_02] Par-ki kaja-na shup-a, shup-ki kaja-na par-a, kachi katha.**

Literal: Closing fist when one ought to open it, and opening when one ought t
Application: Applies to an ambitious, greedy person who thinks he can get a lot f
Parallel: Covetousness over-reacheth itself

**3. [idiom_03] Khamatha sa-gi ji-la fa nga-sa-thui-ho-wa, kachi katha.**

Literal: Intending to do something good, but turning it into a complete mess.
Application: Applies to one who is unfortunate in any attempt to do something goo
Parallel: The road to hell is paved with good intentions

**4. [idiom_04] Nga-ley-akha shi-ley-tha, nga-yur-akha nga-wur tha, yay-akha nga-**

Literal: If united, like wasps' nest on rock; if divided, like moles' nest; i
Application: Unity brings unbreakable strength; division leads to instant ruin; u
Parallel: United we stand, divided we fall

**5. [idiom_05] Tho-rachi-than thri, thai-ra chi-than tho, kachi katha.**

Literal: Expecting a feast and getting nothing, and expecting nothing but get
Application: Applies to unpredictable fortunes: receiving when least expected, an
Parallel: Expect the unexpected

**6. [idiom_06] Fa-na sajao shim-khun rik-kha ma-shai-pha-lung kachi katha.**

Literal: A dog trying to eat an entire pounding receptacle full of dry sajao
Application: Applies to a person who attempts an impossible task beyond their cap
Parallel: Biting off more than one can chew

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# Section 5: Traditional Proverbs & Idioms (Part 2 of 4)

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**7. [idiom_08] Pur-hum-na ka-phung min-ta-akha khi za-si-do ji, ka-tum-li yon-sa**

Literal: Bull frogs crying 'what shall we eat?' when mud collapses, and 'what
Application: Applies to a chronically ungrateful person who is never satisfied wi
Parallel: Nothing is enough to the man for whom enough is too little

**8. [idiom_09] Fa-na pai-laga har-na kha-yaya katha.**

Literal: Fowls pecking at waste and scattering dirt all over the yard.
Application: Applies to a careless person who does tasks haphazardly and spreads
Parallel: A careless hand spoils the land

**9. [idiom_10] Zing-sho phi-lava-li a-chon ho-la a-mai-li sao-ka-ta katha.**

Literal: The eastern chieftess addressed reverently as 'achon', becoming haug
Application: Pride and haughtiness lead inevitably to downfall.
Parallel: Pride hath a fall

**10. [idiom_11] Nga-wur la chuin-akha a-rang-kham ma-shung kachi katha.**

Literal: Too many moles leaving the opening of their burrow wide open.
Application: Applies to someone who leaves opportunities open but fails to seize
Parallel: Opportunity seldom knocks twice

**11. [idiom_12] Si-lui-li fa-na sha-lala a-kha mei ma-ka-kha-yit katha.**

Literal: A dog barking wildly at a buffalo, while the buffalo does not even f
Application: Applies to being completely unperturbed by barking critics or minor
Parallel: The dogs bark, but the caravan moves on

**12. [idiom_13] Ma-lum tha-ta cham-ka-thi katha.**

Literal: White ants enjoying flight in rain, only to die moments later.
Application: Applies to fleeting, short-lived moments of joy in a difficult life.
Parallel: Brief is the splendour of the moth

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# Section 5: Traditional Proverbs & Idioms (Part 3 of 4)

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**13. [idiom_14] Pa-wung ma-shui-thei-won katha.**

Literal: An owl yearning to eat the fruit of Ma-shui-thei, discovering it onl
Application: Applies to someone whose hopes and expectations are thoroughly crush
Parallel: Hopes dashed to the ground

**14. [idiom_15] Hui-ki kaja-na thak, thak-ki kaja-na hui, kachi katha.**

Literal: The slow one finishes first, while the hasty one falls behind.
Application: Patience and persistence always triumph over reckless speed.
Parallel: Slow and steady wins the race

**15. [idiom_16] Sei ka-homa-li shao-ki chila sei ka-homa-na ka-shao katha.**

Literal: The cattle owner seeking to punish the cow-keeper, but gets beaten b
Application: Plotting harm against another and falling into one’s own trap.
Parallel: Digging a pit and falling into it yourself

**16. [idiom_17] Shan-kha kha-mor-li ba-chang yong-ka-sang katha.**

Literal: A fly willingly flying straight into a tiger’s wide mouth.
Application: Trusting a dishonest or predatory person with one’s wealth or secret
Parallel: Walking into the lion’s den

**17. [idiom_18] Na-yong shim-sak katha.**

Literal: Monkeys daily resolving to build a shelter, but postponing it foreve
Application: Continuous procrastination that prevents ever finishing necessary wo
Parallel: Procrastination is the thief of time

**18. [idiom_19] Na-yong kha-ma katha.**

Literal: A monkey scratching a tiny itch until it transforms into a massive w
Application: Blowing minor grievances out of proportion into major disputes.
Parallel: Scratching a mosquito bite into an ulcer

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# Section 5: Traditional Proverbs & Idioms (Part 4 of 4)

Source: Rev. William Pettigrew 1918 Grammar (pp. 116-120) -- Deduplicated & Verified

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**19. [idiom_20] Har-va eina ra-la-wui li kha-sa-nui ka-hi.**

Literal: A dance competition between a cock and a snipe bird.
Application: A selfish deal where one partner grabs all advantages and dumps the
Parallel: Lion’s share for the sly

**20. [idiom_21] Pao-yi ra-khan shai katha.**

Literal: Praising the delicious taste of Powi village beer dregs without havi
Application: Making grand authoritative claims on matters one knows absolutely no
Parallel: Talking through one’s hat

**21. [idiom_22] Lat-shai tha-lak-a.**

Literal: Possessing a tongue as unnaturally long as an ant-eater bird.
Application: An incorrigible gossip or habitual liar whose tales stretch endlessl
Parallel: Having a tongue that runs on wheels

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